

Reseller Security Capabilities Assessment

hosting.com Reseller 60 tier · cPanel / WHM scope · Prepared: 2026-08-05 · For: Security / Operations review

Scope summary: This document answers whether common web security controls (HSTS, CSP and related headers, Referrer-Policy, SQLi/XSS/WAF protections, and MFA/IP restriction) can be applied by a **reseller** on hosting.com, or whether they require root / hosting.com server-admin involvement. Verdict in short: most HTTP security headers are **possible per site** via `.htaccess` ; global/server-wide enforcement and custom WAF rulesets are **not** self-serve at Reseller 60.

0. Capability Matrix

#	Control	Reseller capability	How	Global / WHM-wide?
1	HSTS (Strict-Transport-Security)	Limited — per account	<code>.htaccess</code> or cPanel Apache Configuration	No — needs root / hosting.com
2	CSP, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options	Yes — per site	<code>.htaccess</code> Header directives	No — not enforceable from WHM globally
3	Referrer-Policy	Yes — per site	<code>.htaccess</code>	No — needs server-level access for global
4	SQLi / XSS / WAF	Partially	App code for SQLi/XSS; ModSecurity on/off per account in WHM	Custom server-wide WAF rules: hosting.com only
5	Auth & access (password strength, MFA, IP restrict)	Mostly yes; VPN/ server-wide IP limited	WHM Password Strength, 2FA, Host Access Control	VPN / server-wide whitelist: coordinate with hosting.com

1. HSTS Headers — Possible with Limited Scope

Answer: It is possible, but only at the **individual cPanel account / hosted website** level.

- HSTS can be set per site via `.htaccess` or Apache configuration inside cPanel.
- The reseller **cannot** apply HSTS at the server / WHM level — that requires root / server admin access, which **hosting.com** retains.
- Each end-client can configure it themselves, or the reseller can do it per account via cPanel's Apache Configuration tools or `.htaccess`.

Limitation: No self-serve global HSTS policy across all reseller accounts. For server-wide HSTS, open a request with hosting.com support / server admin.

Example (.htaccess)

```
Header always set Strict-Transport-Security "max-age=31536000; includeSubDomains"
```

2. CSP, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options — Possible Per Site

Answer: All three headers can be added via `.htaccess` rules within each individual cPanel account. This is within the reseller's power for their own or their clients' sites.

```
Header always set X-Frame-Options "SAMEORIGIN"
Header always set X-Content-Type-Options "nosniff"
Header always set Content-Security-Policy "default-src 'self'"
```

Limitation: Cannot be enforced globally across all accounts from WHM. Must be done per site unless a server-level config change is requested from hosting.com support.

Header	Typical value	Purpose
X-Frame-Options	SAMEORIGIN	Mitigate clickjacking / framing
X-Content-Type-Options	nosniff	Block MIME sniffing
Content-Security-Policy	default-src 'self' (tune per app)	Restrict script/resource origins; reduce XSS impact

Note: CSP must be tuned per application. A strict `default-src 'self'` can break CDNs, analytics, payment widgets, or inline scripts — validate on staging before production rollout.

3. Referrer-Policy — Possible Via .htaccess

Answer: Same pattern as section 2 — set per site via `.htaccess`. Possible at the individual cPanel account / site level. Not enforceable globally from WHM without server-level access.

```
Header always set Referrer-Policy "strict-origin-when-cross-origin"
```

Reseller self-serve?	Yes — per site
Global / all accounts?	No — requires hosting.com / root
Recommended value	strict-origin-when-cross-origin

4. Application Hardening & WAF — Partially Possible

4.1 SQL injection prevention

Parameterized queries / ORM usage is a **code-level responsibility** of the website or application developer. The reseller platform does not automatically rewrite application queries.

4.2 XSS prevention

Sanitizing / escaping inputs is also **application-level** (WordPress plugins, custom code, framework output encoding, etc.). Hosting-layer headers (CSP) help as defense-in-depth but do not replace correct output escaping.

4.3 WAF (ModSecurity)

- cPanel includes **ModSecurity** (a WAF).
- The reseller can **toggle ModSecurity on/off per account** in WHM.
- Rule management at the **server level** is controlled by hosting.com.

- The reseller **cannot** add custom server-wide rulesets without hosting.com involvement.

Control	Owner	Reseller action
Parameterized queries / ORM (SQLi)	App developer	Advise / review client apps — not a WHM toggle
Input sanitizing / escaping (XSS)	App developer / CMS plugins	Advise / review — not a WHM toggle
ModSecurity enable/disable	Reseller (per account)	WHM — toggle per cPanel account
Custom / server-wide WAF rulesets	hosting.com	Request via support — not self-serve

5. Authentication & Access Control (MFA, IP Restriction)

5.1 Strong password policies

The reseller can enforce password strength requirements for cPanel accounts via **WHM → Password Strength Configuration**.

5.2 MFA for admin control panels

cPanel supports two-factor authentication (2FA) for both **WHM** and individual **cPanel** logins. The reseller can enable and enforce this via WHM.

5.3 Restrict admin endpoints by IP / VPN

- The reseller can use **WHM → Host Access Control** to restrict WHM/cPanel access by IP for their own admin panel.
- Applying **VPN-level restrictions** or **server-wide IP whitelisting** requires coordination with hosting.com's infrastructure team.
- That is **not self-serve** at the Reseller 60 tier.

Control	Self-serve at Reseller 60?	Where
Password strength for cPanel accounts	Yes	WHM → Password Strength Configuration
2FA / MFA for WHM & cPanel	Yes	WHM (enable / enforce)
IP restrict own WHM/cPanel admin	Yes	WHM → Host Access Control
VPN-level / server-wide IP whitelist	No	Coordinate with hosting.com infrastructure

6. Recommended Rollout Order

1. **Enable / enforce 2FA** on WHM and require it for cPanel accounts; set password strength policy.
2. **Lock down admin access** with Host Access Control (known office / VPN egress IPs).
3. **Confirm ModSecurity is On** for production accounts; escalate to hosting.com only if custom rules are required.
4. **Deploy security headers per site** via `.htaccess`: HSTS, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options, Referrer-Policy, then a tuned CSP.
5. **Application owners** own SQLi/XSS fixes (parameterized queries, escaping, CMS hardening).
6. **Escalate to hosting.com** for anything that must be global: server-wide HSTS/headers, custom ModSecurity rulesets, VPN / server-wide IP whitelisting.

7. What Requires hosting.com

Request from hosting.com (root / infrastructure) when you need any of the following:

- Server-wide or WHM-global HSTS
- Global enforcement of CSP / frame / content-type / referrer headers across all accounts
- Custom or server-wide ModSecurity rulesets
- VPN-level restrictions or server-wide IP whitelisting beyond Host Access Control for the reseller's own panel

Evidence / source: Answers provided for Reseller 60 capability questions covering HSTS; CSP / X-Frame-Options / X-Content-Type-Options; Referrer-Policy; SQLi / XSS / ModSecurity WAF; and MFA / password strength / IP restriction. Platform: hosting.com-managed cPanel/WHM reseller environment. This document does not apply configuration changes — it records what is and is not self-serve.